

Languages

When player characters wish to speak with monsters, it is often useful to be able to speak several languages. All characters and monsters capable of speech speak the language of their alignment (Lawful, Neutral, or Chaotic). The "common tongue" (or more simply "Common") is spoken by most humans, dwarves, elves, and halflings. Many monsters speak their own language, named after the monster. Any monster with its own language has a 20% chance of also speaking Common (except dragons, who always speak Dragon and Common if able to speak at all).

A character with an above-average Intelligence score (13-18) may learn additional languages. Note that as a part of the special abilities of the class, both dwarves and elves already speak additional languages. Some suggested languages besides Common and the alignment languages are:

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| 1. Bugbear | 8. Gnome | 15. Medusa |
| 2. Doppelganger | 9. Goblin | 16. Minotaur |
| 3. Dragon | 10. Halfling | 17. Ogre |
| 4. Dwarvish | 11. Harpy | 18. Orc |
| 5. Elvish | 12. Hobgoblin | 19. Pixie |
| 6. Gargoyle | 13. Kobold | 20. Human Dialect |
| 7. Gnoll | 14. Lizard Man | |

The DM may wish to use more than one human language or dialect for his or her campaign world. The choice of the name of the language (if any) is left up to each DM. Note also that "human-type" monsters such as Bandits, Berserkers, and Lycanthropes will either speak Common or a human dialect of the DM's invention.

Inheritance

If the DM wishes, a player may name an heir to inherit his or her worldly possessions upon the death of the character. The local authorities will, of course, take 10% in taxes, before giving the inheritance to the heir. This heir must *always* be a newly rolled-up first level character. This "inheritance" should only occur *once* per player.

"Hopeless Characters"

Sometimes, a player may "roll up" a character who is below average in every ability, or who has more than one very low (3-6) ability score (such as a fighter with very low Dexterity and Constitution). The DM may declare the character to be not suited for dangerous adventure, and the player may be allowed to roll up a new character in place of the "hopeless" one.

EXAMPLE OF CREATING A PLAYER CHARACTER

- A printed character sheet is being used for this example, so it is not necessary to write down the ability names.
- 3d6 are rolled six times with the results of 15, 7, 11, 13, 14, and 8. These numbers are recorded in pencil next to (not in) the appropriate box.
- The highest ability score rolled was Strength; the player decides to make the character a fighter. As a new character, the character is, of course, 1st level.
- A fighter has no special class abilities, so "None" is recorded under SPECIAL ABILITY DETAILS.
- The player realizes that the character would earn 10% extra experience points rather than 5% extra experience points if the character's prime requisite (Strength) were 16 instead of 15. So, the player lowers the character's Wisdom score from 11 to 9 in order to raise the Strength score from 15 to 16. The character's Intelligence is already below average, so no further adjustments can be made. The final scores of 16, 7, 9, 13, 14, and 8 are recorded in the appropriate boxes.
- The player notes the bonuses and penalties due to the character's ability scores:
 - A **Strength** score of 16 gives the character +10% earned experience and a bonus of +2 on "to hit" and damage rolls and for opening doors.
 - An **Intelligence** score of 7 means that the fighter can write simple Common words.
 - A **Wisdom** score of 9 gives the fighter normal magic-based saving throws.
 - A **Dexterity** score of 13 gives the fighter a +1 on "to hit" rolls for missile attacks and improves Armor Class by -1.
 - A **Constitution** score of 14 gives the character a +1 bonus when rolling a die (d8) to determine hit points.
 - A **Charisma** score of 8 gives the fighter a -1 penalty when checking for reactions, and allows a maximum of 3 retainers whose morale score will be 6.
- Current experience is marked as "0", and 2000 is marked as the total necessary to become a 2nd level fighter.
- The player rolls 1d8 to determine the number of hit points the character has as a 1st level fighter. A roll of 5 +1 due to the Constitution bonus, equals 6 hit points.
- The player decides to make the character Lawful, so Lawful is marked for Alignment.
- For gold, the player rolls an 11 on 3d6, then multiplies by 10, which gives the character 110 gold pieces (gp) with which to buy equipment. 110 gp is recorded under MONEY on the back of the character sheet.
- The player decides on the following list of equipment: chain mail armor (40 gp), a shield (10 gp), a sword (10 gp), a short bow (25 gp), a quiver of 20 arrows (5 gp), 1 silver-tipped arrow (5 gp), a 50' rope (1 gp), a 10' pole (1 gp), 12 iron spikes (1 gp), 6 torches (1 gp), 1 week's standard rations (5 gp), a large sack (2 gp), 1 quart of wine (1 gp), and a wine skin (1 gp). The player would have liked to have purchased plate mail armor, but to do so would have meant giving up a bow. The equipment is listed on the back of the character sheet. Since 108 gp were spent, the "110" is erased from under MONEY, and replaced with a "2".
- Chain mail & shield is Armor Class 4. The character's Dexterity bonus improves the Armor Class by -1, so 3 is listed under Armor Class.
- A first level character needs a roll of 10 to hit Armor Class 9, an 11 to hit Armor Class 8, a 12 to hit Armor Class 7, and so on. A 1st level fighter needs a 12 to make a saving throw vs. Poison or Death Ray, a 13 to save versus Magic Wands, and so forth. The information is recorded in the appropriate boxes or circles. In actual combat, the fighter will add 2 to the "to hit" roll for hand-to-hand combat due to the Strength bonus, and will add +1 to the "to hit" rolls when firing a missile, due to the Dexterity bonus.
- This player is female and decides that her character will also be female. Inspired by the name of Morgan le Fay from Arthurian legends, the player decides that the name of Morgan Ironwolf would be a good name for a fighter.